

Editorial

Dear Readers,

It's the festival season, and is accompanied by a lot of good news. The IT biggies have started hiring again. Some of them have also announced their intention to restart the process of appraisals and increments.

But, did the demand for open source professionals ever go down? Our interaction with the industry indicated that while there was a dampening effect of the salary levels being offered, the demand for open source professionals remained the same as ever!

Whether it was the small and medium IT firms or the biggies—they kept looking for professionals with skills in open source projects. In fact, as more and more open source projects are being recognised as 'business ready', the demand for the skillsets to work on these projects has also been increasing. For example, projects like Drupal (a popular content management system), or Pentaho (a business intelligence software), are creating many jobs in India.

In fact, there's quite a demand for IT implementers from the Indian industry, as a whole. But the big issue is that everyone wants people with proven skills, and that's where the Catch-22 arises. If you don't get a chance to work, how will you prove yourself; and if you don't prove yourself, how will you get work?

Well, in the open source world, even this problem can be resolved. Pick up projects of your interest. Start reading about them, trying them out, and then contributing to them. If you do learn something, your knowledge will surely get recognised by the project team, and its community. That recognition is your 'experience certificate'. In fact, from all the success stories I have been hearing, there are very high chances that you will get a call for an interview, even without you having applied for a job!

Of course, preparing for that interview will be your next challenge. But, we have some valuable tips for you—as you might have noticed from our cover this month. S.G. Ganesh, who's been a regular contributor

to *LINUX For You*, has written a book titled 'Cracking the C, C++ and Java Interview', which has recently been published. He's picked some interesting chapters from his book to share exclusively with LFY readers. Turn to Page 22 to get valuable insights on how to handle job interviews, which have been shared by a veteran who's been on both sides of the table.

If you don't get a chance to work, how will you prove yourself; and if you don't prove yourself, how will you get work?

Here's a little secret: contributing to *LINUX For You* or *LinuxForU.com*, and getting your articles published can be the road to fame too. From authoring articles to authoring books, speaking at seminars, giving keynotes, and then perhaps becoming a top-notch consultant could be a great way to promote open source in India.

Wish you a joyous festive season on behalf of the entire *LINUX For You* team...

Best Wishes!



Rahul Chopra
Editor, LFY
rahul@efyindia.com